



Partly sunny 40/34 • Tomorrow: Shower 48/32 **B20**

Democracy Dies in Darkness

FRIDAY, JANUARY 16, 2026 • \$4

Iran says protester won't be executed

Airspace reopens as U.S. adds new sanctions on officials over crackdown

BY KAREEM FAHIM, LOVEDAY MORRIS AND BURHAN YUKSEKKAS

ISTANBUL — Iran reopened its airspace early Thursday after a brief overnight closure, as the country's judiciary announced that a young Iranian man who rights groups said was facing execution would not be put to death.

The resumption of flights over Iran, according to tracking data posted Thursday on the site Flightradar24, came as the Trump administration weighs possible military strikes against the country.

The White House has framed the potential strikes as a response to the Iranian government's brutal nationwide crackdown on a protest movement. Rights groups say thousands have been killed.

The Trump administration imposed new sanctions on Iran on Thursday, including on officials accused of roles in the crackdown on protests. Among the officials and entities included is Ali Larijani, the secretary of the Supreme National Security Council, who the U.S. Treasury said had called for violence against protesters.

"The United States stands with the Iranian people, who are protesting for their natural rights," State Department spokesperson Tommy Pigott said in a statement Thursday. "We will continue to deny the regime

SEE IRAN ON A13

End-of-life care falls on more spouses

Costs, longer lifespans, smaller families mean seniors face task alone

BY SHANNON NAJMABADI

Lori Gonzalez never trained to be a nurse. But at 75, she is her husband's full-time caregiver — helping him bathe, dress and move about their Phoenix home. She makes sure he eats, and she knows not to argue when he's agitated or confused. And she hasn't left him home alone in three years.

Gonzalez knows that his dementia will only worsen and that she'll be tending to him as her own health challenges mount, including the severe stenosis that leaves her back stiff and in pain.

"I don't know when, I don't know exactly what it'll look like," said Gonzalez, a former grade school librarian. But "I will be the primary caregiver."

While caring for an aging person can be financially and emotionally draining for adult children, the undertaking raises a separate set of challenges for spouses. These partners are typically seniors themselves — close to half are 75 or older — and they

SEE CAREGIVERS ON A20



DANYIL BASHAKOV/AP

As politicians trade barbs, Kyiv shivers

Zelensky slams city officials as residents lose power during below-freezing temperatures

BY DAVID L. STERN AND SERHII KOROLCHUK

KYIV — Devastating attacks on Kyiv's energy system over the past week have left hundreds of thousands in the cold and dark, as temperatures plunged well below freezing, sparking a war of words between President Volodymyr Zelensky and the mayor over the plight of the capital's residents.

In Kyiv, a frigid lottery of sorts is playing out in which limited resources mean residents may have power, heat or water but almost never all three depending on where they live in the city and on which floors their apartments are located.

As temperatures plummet — and are forecast to remain low for days — energy workers are scrambling to restore utilities to millions of Ukrainians in the capital and other major urban centers across the country.

Zelensky declared a state of emergency in the energy sector



ALINA SMUTKO/REUTERS

TOP: A man smokes outside of an emergency tent in Kyiv on Tuesday. Russia's attacks against Ukraine's energy infrastructure have cut power to many residents. ABOVE: Yuliia Chumak warms the hands of her daughter, Kvitoslava, 3, on Wednesday.

on Wednesday night and then slammed the Kyiv city administration for how it has dealt with the crisis.

"Unfortunately, Kyiv has done much less — very little has been

done in the capital," he said in his regular evening address after convening a special meeting on the energy situation. "And even these days, I don't see any urgency. We need to urgently rectify

this now."

A few hours later, Mayor Vitali Klitschko responded.

"What 'intensity' in the work in Kyiv in an emergency situation does the president not see, in particular, in recent days, as he said?" he wrote on Telegram, saying "utility workers are working around-the-clock in the bitter cold to repair critical infrastructure."

"Such statements, first and foremost, negate the selfless work of thousands of people, specialists," Klitschko said, adding that he saw the criticism as "nothing but hate." He said that "at least I am speaking honestly and warning people about the extremely difficult situation. And I don't care about any ratings or illusory elections."

The war of words underlines the political turmoil in the country as Zelensky's administration, weakened by corruption charges, appears to be trying to score points against his political rivals.

SEE UKRAINE ON A14

Commanders' future digs pay homage to RFK

Stadium design boasts sculpted roof, incorporates elements of franchise's iconic former home

BY TOM SCHAD

A sweeping, translucent roof. Main entryways on the same axis as the Washington Monument and the U.S. Capitol. A grand colonnade.

Those are among the most striking features in the conceptual renderings of the Washington Commanders' new stadium released Thursday morning, the first glimpses of the structure that will be erected on the former RFK Stadium site.

The images, which show the exterior of the proposed stadium from different vantage points and in different lighting, are the first to be released by the Commanders since they hired HKS as their lead architect in November. While the design process is ongoing and changes are possible, the renderings reflect the major design principles agreed upon by the Commanders, including principal owner Josh Harris, and their lead architects.

SEE STADIUM ON A10



WASHINGTON COMMANDERS AND HKS

The Commanders' new stadium, seen here in concept, will be constructed on the former site of RFK Stadium. The venue, with a projected capacity of 70,000, is slated to be finished by 2030.

Trump ups the ante in Minn.

RAISES PROSPECT OF TROOP DEPLOYMENT

Insurrection Act on the table to quell protests

This article is by Molly Hennessy-Fiske, Maegan Vazquez, Justine McDaniel, Adela Suliman and Derek Hawkins

MINNEAPOLIS — President Donald Trump threatened to invoke the Insurrection Act in Minnesota on Thursday, raising the prospect of sending U.S. troops into Minneapolis, despite opposition from state and local leaders, to quell protests over a recent federal immigration enforcement surge.

Trump, in a Truth Social post, put the onus on Minnesota politicians to stop protesters from "attacking" Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents. Trump wrote that if the state couldn't calm the protesters, whom he referred to as "insurrectionists," he would "institute the INSURRECTION ACT ... and quickly put an end to the travesty that is taking place in that once great State."

Federal agents have flooded the streets of Minneapolis in recent days, detaining people, pulling them from their vehicles, stopping U.S. citizens and shooting two people, one of whom was killed. Residents have responded by protesting the agents' use of force and the

SEE MINNEAPOLIS ON A6

Insurrection Act: What is the law, and how could Trump wield it? **A7**

President accepts gift of Machado Peace Prize

Laureate seeks to win favor, regain influence over Venezuela's future

BY MICHAEL BIRNBAUM AND MARÍA LUISA PAÚL

President Donald Trump on Thursday accepted a Nobel Peace Prize medal from Venezuelan opposition leader María Corina Machado, a striking bid by the current laureate to sway a U.S. president who recently declined to support her challenge to Venezuela's ruling regime.

The gesture came 12 days after the U.S. president toppled Venezuela's longtime leader, Nicolás Maduro, then chose to preserve ties with the existing regime rather than back Machado, whose movement claimed victory in 2024 elections.

Machado's meeting with Trump was an effort to regain influence over Venezuela's future as the threat of U.S. military action continues to hang over the new leadership in Caracas — and as Trump has demanded Venezuela open its oil fields to U.S. companies. Machado was her nation's democratic leader-in-waiting until Trump backed the existing vice

SEE MACHADO ON A15

IN THE NEWS

Manufacturing jobs President Donald Trump promised that tariffs would bring a factory boom. So far, it has been a bust. **A16**

A question of impeachment Many Democrats are urging the party not to make calls for the president's removal from office a centerpiece of their midterm campaigns. **A3**

THE NATION

The president unveiled his vision for a "Great Healthcare Plan," a grab bag of initiatives. **A3**
Trump's pardons have dismayed prosecutors who meticulously built their cases. **A10**

THE WORLD

Protests and a deadly crackdown in Iran both echo and diverge from previous discontent. **A12**
As relations between China and Japan deteriorate, both are wooing South Korea. **A13**

THE ECONOMY

Grok was disabled on the X platform for some users, but the stand-alone Grok app was still undressing people. **A16**
New tariffs on high-end semiconductors made abroad by U.S. companies are a novel way to target foreign sales of the chips. **A17**

STYLE

"Members Only," a Netflix reality series, lays bare the insecurities of affluent Floridians. **B1**

SPORTS

The fix was in, according to federal prosecutors in an indictment that alleges point-shaving in at least 29 college basketball games. **B7**

THE REGION

Janeese Lewis George launched her bid for D.C. mayor, pledging universal child care and social housing. **B13**

WEEKEND

With a revived civil rights album, jazz singer and Howard lecturer Christie Dashiell registers her resistance.

BUSINESS NEWS.....A16
COMICS.....B4
OBITUARIES.....B15
OPINION PAGES.....A18
TELEVISION.....B6
WORLD NEWS.....A12

CONTENT © 2026
The Washington Post
Year 149, No. 54463

